FREE CHRISTMAS CASE · NOT IN THE BOOKS

THE CASE OF THE MUDDLED STOCKINGS

THE LAST DAY OF TERM · CONKERBURY VILLAGE HALL

It was the last day before the Christmas holidays, and the Conkerbury Detectives were helping to decorate the village hall for the Christmas party.

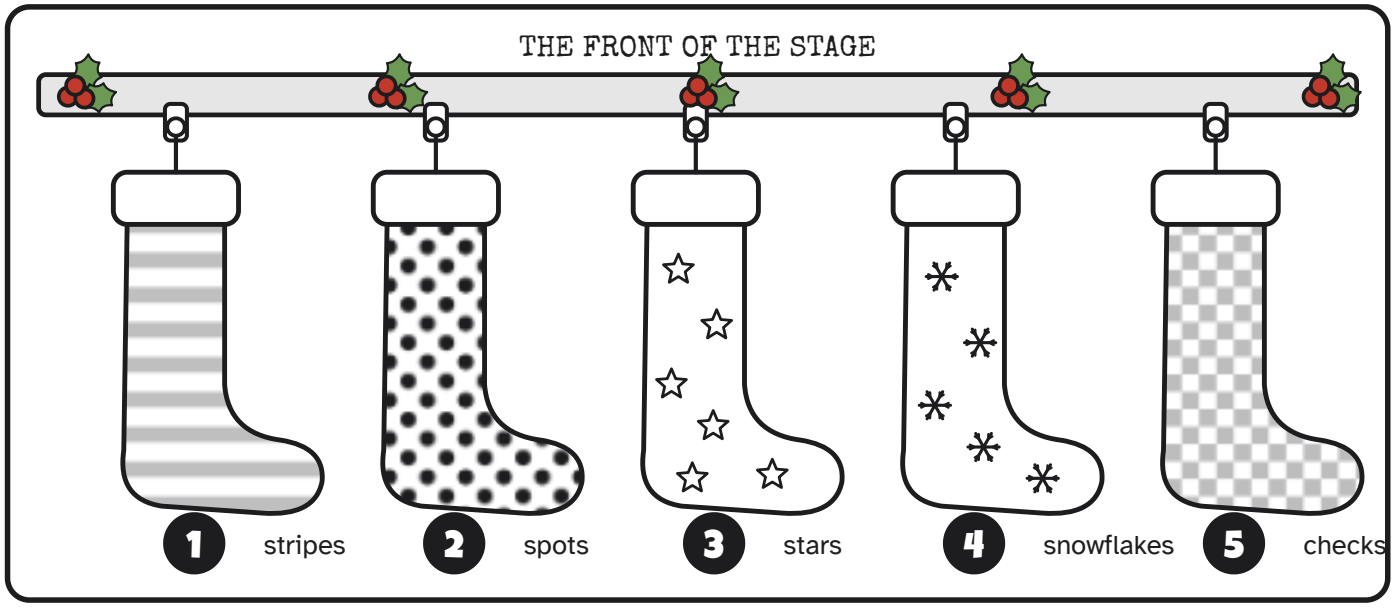
Mrs Doyle had knitted each detective a Christmas stocking: five of them, all different. She hung them in a row on five pegs along the front of the stage, and tied a name tag to each one. Then she popped a treat inside every stocking.

Just then, the hall doors blew open. A great gust of icy wind whooshed across the hall, and all five name tags fluttered off and landed in a heap on the floor.

"Oh, fiddlesticks," said Mrs Doyle. "Now I can't remember whose is whose. And I've got mince pies in the oven."



OLLIE: "Leave it to us, Mrs Doyle," said Ollie. "Five stockings, five detectives, and no peeking inside. Easy." Biscuit wagged his tail so hard that his whole body wagged too.



YOUR MISSION

Work out **whose stocking is on each peg**, and **which treat is inside each one.** No peeking: use the clues and the logic grid!

DIFFICULTY ●●○○○ Rookie to Junior · ages 8–12 · about 20–30 minutes · you need a pencil

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THE CLUES

- **C1** Biscuit's stocking has the **sausage chew** in it. (Sweets and chocolate are bad for dogs!)
- **C2** Biscuit's stocking is covered in **snowflakes**, because he loves rolling in snow.
- **C3** Ffion's stocking hangs **right next to** Biscuit's.
- **C4** Priya's stocking is not checked, and it doesn't have stripes or spots.
- **C5** Ollie's stocking is at **one end** of the row.
- **C6** The **orange** is in the starry stocking.
- **C7** The **toffee** is in the stocking right next to the orange.
- **C8** Ffion doesn't like nuts, so **rocky road** (which is full of nuts) is **not** in her stocking.

THE LOGIC GRIDS

Put a ✓ when you know something is true. Then put a ✗ in every other square in that row and column. Every row and every column ends up with exactly one ✓.

WHO?	Peg 1 (stripes)	Peg 2 (spots)	Peg 3 (stars)	Peg 4 (snowflakes)	Peg 5 (checks)
Priya					
Ollie					
Ffion					
Alfie					
Biscuit					

WHAT?	Fudge	Rocky road	Orange	Sausage chew	Toffee
Peg 1 (stripes)					
Peg 2 (spots)					
Peg 3 (stars)					
Peg 4 (snowflakes)					
Peg 5 (checks)					



PRIYA: "The WHO grid tells you each detective's peg. The WHAT grid tells you what's inside the stocking on each peg. Finish the WHO grid first!"

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CASE SOLVED? FILL IN THE TAGS

Detective	Peg	Pattern	Treat inside
Priya			
Ollie			
Ffion			
Alfie			
Biscuit			

MAKE YOUR ANSWER CODE

Write the **peg numbers** in this order: Priya, Ollie, Ffion, Alfie, Biscuit. For example, if Priya was on peg 2, Ollie on 4, Ffion on 1, Alfie on 5 and Biscuit on 3, the code would be 24153 (it isn't!).

☐☐☐☐☐

Check it at **conkerburydetectives.co.uk/check.html** (choose **Free printables**, then **The Muddled Stockings**). If it's wrong, the checker tells you which clue to look at again, without giving the answer away.

STUCK? HINTS

Read one hint at a time, then have another go.

HINT 1

Start with Biscuit (C1 and C2). Which peg has the snowflake stocking? Fill in his row on the grid.

HINT 2

C4 tells you Priya's pattern, so you know her peg. Then C3 and C5 place Ffion and Ollie, and Alfie gets the last peg.

HINT 3

For the treats: C6 puts the orange on one peg, C7 puts the toffee next to it, and C8 decides the last two.



ALFIE: "Draw the five pegs in a row on scrap paper and move little name labels around. That's how I do the 'next to' clues."

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ANSWER PAGE

CASE CLOSED

No peeking! Only read this once you've made your answer code, or if you're stuck after all three hints.

THE ANSWER: 31524

Priya peg 3 (stars, orange), Ollie peg 1 (stripes, rocky road), Ffion peg 5 (checks, fudge), Alfie peg 2 (spots, toffee), Biscuit peg 4 (snowflakes, sausage chew).

1. C1 and C2: Biscuit has the sausage chew and the snowflake stocking, which hangs on **peg 4**.
2. C4: Priya's stocking isn't checks, stripes or spots, and snowflakes is Biscuit's. So Priya has the stars: **peg 3**.
3. C3: Ffion is next to Biscuit (peg 4). Peg 3 is taken, so Ffion is on **peg 5**.
4. C5: Ollie is at one end. Peg 5 is taken, so Ollie is on **peg 1**. That leaves **peg 2** for Alfie.
5. C6: the orange is in the starry stocking, Priya's on peg 3. C7: the toffee is next to it, on peg 2 or peg 4. Peg 4 has the sausage chew, so the toffee is on **peg 2** (Alfie).
6. That leaves fudge and rocky road for Ollie and Ffion. C8: Ffion doesn't have the rocky road, so Ffion has the **fudge** and Ollie has the **rocky road**.
7. Answer code (pegs for Priya, Ollie, Ffion, Alfie, Biscuit): **31524**.

WHAT HAPPENED NEXT

Mrs Doyle came back from the kitchen with a tray of mince pies and found five name tags tied neatly back on five stockings.

"How on earth did you do that without peeking?" she asked. "Logic," said Priya. "And Biscuit sniffed out his own," said Ffion. It was true. Biscuit had been sitting under peg 4 the whole time, staring at it.

Ollie shared his rocky road with everyone except Ffion, who shared her fudge with everyone except Biscuit. Biscuit didn't mind one bit. He had a sausage chew.

FOR GROWN-UPS

This little case is a free extra, written just for this file. It isn't in either book, and it has been checked by computer so there is exactly one answer.

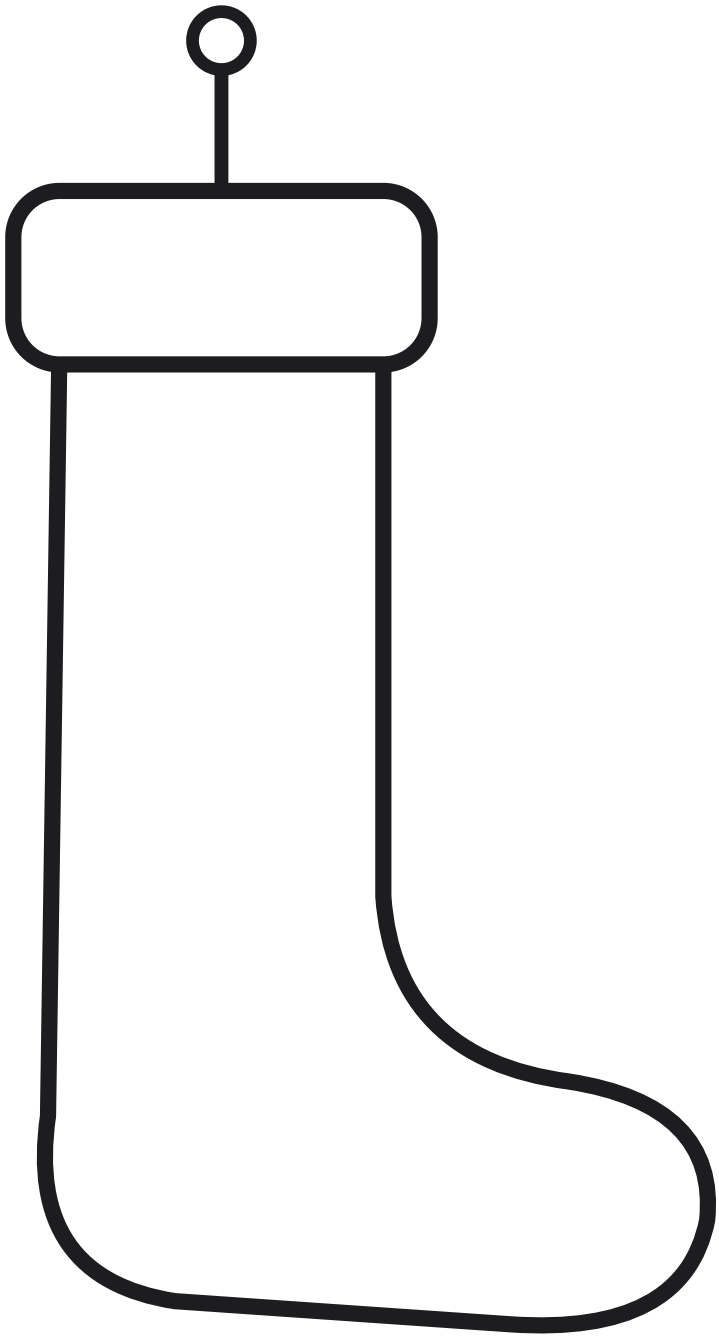
Coming soon: *A Conkerbury Christmas*, the second Conkerbury Detectives casebook, with 24 Advent mysteries, a Secret Paper Chain and a Christmas Day finale. The first book, **The Case of the Missing Conker Champion**, is out now: **https://www.amazon.co.uk/dp/B0HQ1LMJGX**. More free printables (no sign-up) at **conkerburydetectives.co.uk/printables.html**.

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CHRISTMAS ACTIVITY

DESIGN A STOCKING FOR...

Pick a detective (or yourself) and decorate a stocking that suits them



WHOSE IS IT?

_____

IDEAS

Priya: books and pencils. **Ollie:** footballs and the number 9. **Ffion:** tape measures and Welsh dragons. **Alfie:** maps and compasses. **Biscuit:** sausages, obviously.

WHAT'S INSIDE?

Write or draw the treat:

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OFFICIAL CERTIFICATE

CASE CLOSED!

This is to certify that

_____

has solved

THE CASE OF THE MUDDLED STOCKINGS



and is now an official **Junior Detective** of Conkerbury.

_____
Date

Inspector C. Conkerworth
Inspector Cuthbert Conkerworth

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